

Words Worth Eating



HOLIDAY CRAB SOUP

"Rich and creamy!"

1-1 1/2 pounds backfin or
special crab meat
2 medium potatoes, cooked
1 medium onion, cubed
1 rib of celery, cubed
1/4 cup water
8 tablespoons butter, divided
1 tablespoon flour

4 cups milk, divided
1 1/4 teaspoons salt
1/2 teaspoon cracked pepper
1/8 teaspoon ground mace
3 drops Tabasco sauce
1 teaspoon Worcestershire sauce
1 teaspoon lemon juice
2 cups half and half

(over)

*1/4-1/2 teaspoon Old Bay
Seasoning*

*1 sliced lemon, for garnish
paprika*

Gently pick through crab to remove all shell. Mash potatoes until smooth; set aside. Place onion, celery and 1/4 cup water in blender; blend until smooth. Combine onion mixture with 1 tablespoon melted butter and cook over medium heat for 5 minutes stirring constantly; set aside.

Prepare a white sauce from 1 tablespoon butter, 1 tablespoon flour and 1 cup of milk. Bring white sauce to a boil and cook over medium heat for 1 minute. Transfer mixture to a large heavy pot and stir in 1 additional cup of milk, onion mixture, salt and next four ingredients. Gradually add lemon juice stirring constantly. Add mashed potatoes, half and half, crab, 6 tablespoons butter, Old Bay seasoning and remaining 2 cups of milk. Cook over low heat or simmer until hot. Spoon soup into 8-10 bowls. Garnish with lemon and paprika. Serves 8-10.

Note: Be sure to slowly add lemon juice. Can be prepared 1 day ahead.
"This outstanding soup is great for a crowd!"

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